

[Table 71.8](#) shows how the V-top has performed over the decades.

Performance over time. The numbers are close enough that there's not a big difference between them. The 1990s showed the best performance, and the 2000s had the worst.

Failures over time. The 2010s had the highest number of failures with almost a third of the V-tops failing to see price drop more than 5% during that decade. However, the three decades show similar failure rates.

[Table 71.9](#) shows how busted patterns performed. A bust occurs when price breaks out downward (for the V-top), drops less than 10%, and then closes above the top of the pattern.

Busted patterns count. Almost half (46%) of V-tops in bull markets will bust their downward breakouts. Wow. Bear markets do substantially better with “only” 25% busting.

Busted occurrence. I sorted the types of busts into three categories. Single busts happen most often with triple+ (more than two) busts coming in second place. We've seen that behavior in other types of chart patterns, too.

Busted and non-busted performance. I used the performance of V-bottoms as a gauge of how a busted V-top might perform. Single busted V-tops tend to see price soar, performing better than all busted patterns as a group and beating V-bottoms, too. However, you have to guess right that a single bust will occur (as opposed to a double or triple bust). With 84% of V-tops busting just once, that should be easy. Avoid patterns with nearby overhead resistance.